



Mostly cloudy 60/45 • Tomorrow: Mostly sunny 59/49 **B6**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

THURSDAY, MARCH 13, 2025 • \$4

Effort to deport Columbia student hinges on finding by Rubio



STEFAN JEREMIAH/AP

Demonstrators rally outside a federal courthouse in Manhattan on Wednesday in support of Columbia University graduate student Mahmoud Khalil. Secretary of State Marco Rubio has determined that Khalil’s presence in the United States could have “potentially serious adverse foreign policy consequences.” A court hearing provided no information on specific accusations against Khalil, a pro-Palestinian activist and green-card holder. **Story, A3**

Democrats prepare to reject bill to avert shutdown

BY THEODORIC MEYER  
AND LIZ GOODWIN

Senate Democrats say they are prepared to vote to reject the Republicans’ government funding bill, threatening a shutdown if lawmakers do not strike a deal within days.

Not enough Democrats support the bill to clear the 60-vote threshold needed to overcome a filibuster, Minority Leader Charles E. Schumer (D-New York) said on the Senate floor Wednesday, with less than 72 hours before the government is set to shut down. Instead, Democrats are seeking a bill — known as a continuing resolution, or CR — to keep the government open through April 11 while the

Party’s senators agonize over how to keep Trump from gaining more power

two parties complete work on their long-stalled spending bills.

“Republicans chose a partisan path, drafting their continuing resolution without any input — any input — from congressional Democrats,” Schumer said. “Because of that, Republicans do not have the votes in the Senate” to advance the bill.

Still, it is unclear whether the Democrats’ ultimatum will trigger a shutdown when government

funding expires at 12:01 a.m. Saturday. Democrats have not ruled out striking a deal with Republicans to prevent a shutdown by allowing votes on amendments in exchange for their support.

“I’m not sure exactly what their demand is,” Senate Majority Leader John Thune (R-South Dakota) told reporters after Schumer spoke. Democrats might just be seeking a vote on their funding bill and, once it fails, will back Republicans’ bill, he said. The Republican bill is the only path forward that “keeps the government open,” he added. “The question of whether or not it stays funded now is up to the Democrats.”

House Democrats and liberal activists have urged Schumer and

Senate Democrats to vote against the Republican bill, which passed the House on Tuesday with the support of one Democrat, Rep. Jared Golden of Maine. Democrats have criticized President Donald Trump and Republicans for crafting the bill without their input and including \$13 billion in cuts to nondefense programs such as mental health and substance abuse treatment and workforce training.

House Speaker Mike Johnson (R-Louisiana) sent lawmakers home after the House passed the bill, and he would need to recall

SEE SHUTDOWN ON A4

**\$1.1 billion impact:** Democrats’ opposition offered hope to D.C. **B1**

E.U., Canada slap retaliatory tariffs onto U.S. goods

WARNINGS OF MORE TRADE WAR ESCALATION

Trump’s levies on steel and aluminum take effect

BY ELLEN FRANCIS,  
MAHAM JAVAD  
AND TERRENCE MCCOY

BRUSSELS — The European Union and Canada hit back Wednesday at President Donald Trump’s steel and aluminum tariffs with levies of their own on billions of dollars’ worth of U.S. products, including bourbon and motorcycles, while warning of further retaliation.

The European Union unveiled a two-stage response that will target up to \$28 billion in U.S. exports. Canada announced 25 percent tariffs on \$20.7 billion.

The U.S. decision to raise tariffs on all steel and aluminum imports to 25 percent took effect Wednesday — the latest salvo in Trump’s campaign to reshape

America’s trading relationship with the world.

European leaders for months warned that they would retaliate swiftly against new U.S. tariffs, even as they emphasized that a trade war would hurt both sides and tried to negotiate an off-ramp with the Trump administration.

With a deal elusive, the European Commission, the E.U.’s executive branch, said it will reimpose tariffs dating to Trump’s first term on April 1. After consultations, leaders said, the commission will target an additional \$19 billion in products by mid-April.

SEE TARIFFS ON A14

**Allies in Asia:** Nations lobby to avoid U.S. tariffs on metals. **A14**

Price hikes likely despite inflation easing slightly

February report shows relief on gas and airfare, but recession fears linger

BY ANDREW ACKERMAN

Inflation eased more than expected in February, but not enough to assuage fears that a new round of tariffs taking hold Wednesday on steel and aluminum imports would escalate a trade war, threatening higher prices in the months to come.

The consumer price index, a key gauge of inflation, showed that prices rose by 2.8 percent in February from a year earlier, driven by price relief from airfares and gas, the Labor Department said Wednesday. That was cooler than the 3 percent annual gain reported for January and an unexpected

signal of progress in combating high inflation.

White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt praised the inflation report Wednesday as a sign that “the economy is moving in the right direction.” She said in a statement: “This inflation report, much like last week’s jobs report, is far better than the media predicted and the so-called ‘experts’ expected. When will they learn to stop doubting President Trump?”

The inflation report preceded a new wave of tariffs of 25 percent on steel and aluminum imports, which economists have warned could raise prices and weigh down the economy over the coming months.

The European Union and Canada hit back with counter levies Wednesday, announcing new tariffs.

SEE INFLATION ON A5

**Trump voters:** Some are dismayed by early moves on economy. **A5**

End to Social Security’s phone service is off the table

BY HANNAH NATANSON,  
LISA REIN,  
ELIZABETH DWOSKIN  
AND FAIZ SIDDIQUI

The Social Security Administration late Wednesday abandoned plans it was considering to end phone service for millions of Americans filing retirement and disability claims after The Washington Post reported that Elon Musk’s U.S. DOGE Service team was weighing the change to root out alleged fraud.

The shift would have directed elderly and disabled people to rely on the internet and in-person field offices to process their claims, curtailing a service that 73 million Americans have relied on for decades to access earned government benefits.

However, Social Security and White House officials said the administration will still move ahead with another far more limited element of the original

SEE SOCIAL SECURITY ON A2

Ugandan pipeline carries local hopes, global fears

Backers say oil project will boost a poor nation’s economy; climate activists warn of dangers to planet



ESTHER MBABAZI/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Uganda, with plans to be Africa’s newest oil exporter, has begun construction on a 1,000-mile pipeline.

BY CHICO HARLAN  
IN KYARUSHESHA, UGANDA

For its first 88 completed miles, the world’s most controversial oil pipeline system runs in a bulldozed path through the Ugandan countryside.

The pipeline runs past elementary schools lacking electricity. It cuts through the banana groves of a farmer skipping meals to survive the dry season. It knifes past a Pentecostal church whose pastor hopes his children will one day have oil jobs. Then, not long after it passes through this village, it gives way to something unplanned: hundreds of unfinished miles, in a project that is behind schedule and that Western banks have shunned.

Uganda was hoping by now to be on the verge of oil production.

Instead, it is at the center of a global fight — involving governments, climate activists, energy companies and multinational banks — over the future of fossil fuels.

Uganda remains adamant that

SEE PIPELINE ON A10

Peace talks buoy Ukraine but may fall flat in Russia

BY LIZZIE JOHNSON,  
ROBYN DIXON,  
ANASTACIA GALOUCHKA  
AND FRANCESCA EBEL

KYIV — The resumption of U.S. aid and intelligence sharing following peace talks in Jeddah, Saudi Arabia, has reignited hope in Kyiv that Washington is willing to be a partner in ending the war with Moscow, even as resistance to a ceasefire mounted in Russia and the Kremlin declined to immediately endorse the proposal.

Pro-Kremlin Russian analysts, politicians and nationalist military bloggers said Russia would probably reject the ceasefire as a trap that would harm Russian interests and benefit Ukraine.

President Donald Trump said Wednesday that envoys were headed to Moscow with the proposal. “It’s up to Russia now,” he said.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy — whom the

SEE UKRAINE ON A12

IN THE NEWS

**Caught in the middle** Farmers who got aid from the Biden administration for climate- and DEI-related projects face losing funding as the Trump administration makes cuts. **A6**

**Clash in Annapolis** Dozens descended on the Maryland State House to oppose a proposed 2.5 percent business tax. **B1**

**THE NATION**  
**The EPA** said it will roll back dozens of rules, amounting to a massive shift in climate policy. **A2**  
**A judge ordered** the Trump administration to halt penalties it levied against a law firm. **A7**

**THE WORLD**  
**Pakistan’s** military said at least 25 died in a rescue operation after militants hijacked a train. **A8**  
**Million-year-old** bone fragments found in Spain shed new light on human evolution. **A9**

**THE ECONOMY**  
**Oil and gas executives** pulled back on clean-energy pledges as they celebrated Trump’s policies at a summit in Houston. **A13**  
**Foreign firms** may be inadvertently offsetting the costs of expanding the Chinese navy, a report found. **A14**

**THE REGION**  
**A misconduct** hearing began for a prosecutor in cases related to anti-Trump protests stemming from his 2017 inauguration. **B1**  
**A California man** was sentenced to 6½ years in prison for his role in a gold-bar scam in Maryland. **B1**

**SPORTS**  
**American** is going dancing: The Eagles beat Navy in the Patriot League men’s title game, 74–52, for a spot in the NCAA tournament. **D1**

**LOCAL LIVING**  
**Sometimes**, you can go home again — by purchasing the house you grew up in.

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